



“ELON MUSK IS A CONTROL FREAK”

THE EAGERLY ANTICIPATED BIOGRAPHY OF ELON MUSK IS FINALLY HERE. AUTHOR WALTER ISAACSON TALKS ABOUT WHAT HE LEARNT SHADOWING MUSK AND MORE

BY DANNY CYRIL DCRUZE

WALTER ISAACSON is known to tackle very difficult subjects. So, perhaps it was no surprise that he chose to write a biography of Tesla CEO Elon Musk after best-selling books on the lives of Steve Jobs, Albert Einstein, Benjamin Franklin, Jennifer Doudna, and others. Isaacson talks to *Business Today* about the mercurial Musk and the experiences that shaped him. Edited excerpts:



For the past two to three years, you've practically lived with Elon Musk,

attended his meetings, walked in his factories and spent hours interviewing him, his family, friends, co-workers, and even enemies. Now that the book is finally out, how does it feel?

The book is the most interesting and fascinating journey you can imagine because there's not only Elon Musk, but there are many different versions of Elon Musk. There are times when he's a great engineer, there are times when he's giddy and silly, and there are times when he's dark and angry. And so it's a roller-coaster ride

with one of the most impulsive, mercurial people. But it's those traits that have helped him bring us into the era of electric vehicles and to be able to get astronauts into orbit from the US, which even Nasa can't do anymore. He's also created the internet in outer space with Starlink and now he's taking on artificial intelligence. So if you want to learn how to be an innovator, if you want to be an innovator who's going to affect this world, there's nobody better to understand than Elon Musk.



In the book, we go through Musk's childhood in detail. He definitely had a strained relationship with his father. How much of an impact did that have on the Elon Musk we know today?

Elon Musk was forged by the fire of his childhood in South Africa. He knew pain, but he learnt how to deal with it. He knew drama and he learnt how to love drama. You know, he was a kid without very many social skills. [He was] not very good at relating to people, still has that problem. He was a scrawny kid